PROFOUND LOSS

On December 8, India was collectively stunned when news broke that a helicopter carrying the country's top military official—General Bipin Rawat, 63, Chief of India's Defence Staff, responsible for modernising India's defence structure, strategy and priorities—had crashed near Coonoor, Tamil Nadu. A few hours later, the Indian Air Force announced that casualties included almost everyone on board—General Rawat, his wife and 11 members of the armed forces. *Wreckage of General Rawat's IAF Mi-17V5 (right); General Rawat's funeral procession in New Delhi (facing)*



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